

She raised her voice today. Barely. But it cracked.

She said, "Sometimes I think you twist things."

I smiled. "Sometimes?" I asked.

She looked away, embarrassed.

She wasn't ready for that. For someone not defending themselves. For someone turning her doubt into her guilt.

It's not that I enjoy it.

It's just that... it works.

Every time she starts to surface, I push her back down with softness.

With logic.

With care.

She doesn't realize that silence is only comforting when it's chosen.

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